```
dotnet sln add WebApplication1        ❸
```

❶ Creates a solution file called WebApplication1 in the current folder

❷ Creates an empty ASP.NET Core project in a subfolder, WebApplication1

❸ Adds the new project to the solution file

NOTE Visual Studio uses the concept of a solution to work with multiple projects. The example solution consists of a single project, which is listed in the .sln file. If you use a CLI template to create your project, you won't have a .sln file unless you generate it explicitly by using additional .NET CLI templates (listing 3.1).

Whether you use Visual Studio or the .NET CLI, now you have the basic files required to build and run your first ASP.NET Core application.

3.2.2 Building the application

At this point, you have most of the files necessary to run your application, but you've got two steps left. First, you need to ensure all the dependencies used by your project are downloaded to your machine, and second, you need to compile your application so that it can be run.

The first step isn't strictly necessary, as both Visual Studio and the .NET CLI automatically restore packages when they create your project, but it's good to know what's going on. In earlier versions of the .NET CLI, before 2.0, you needed to restore packages manually by using `dotnet restore`.

You can compile your application by choosing Build > Build Solution, pressing the shortcut Ctrl-Shift-B, or running `dotnet build` from the command line. If you build from Visual Studio, the output window shows the progress of the build, and assuming that everything is hunky-dory, Visual Studio compiles your application, ready for running. You can also run the `dotnet build` console commands from the Package Manager Console in Visual Studio.